

Wednesday, April 22, 2026

1:30 a.m. – General Discussion

Commissioners Ron Smith, Chair; Colene Martin, Vice-Chair; Gary Richardson; Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Chair Ron Smith called the meeting to order at 1:30 p.m.

1. Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest

All Commissioners reviewed today's agenda, and it was determined that there are no conflicts of interest.

2. Department Business

a. 2026 Fire Season Workshop

Dave Daniel, Josephine County Sheriff, presented in his role as Interim Emergency Manager and provided an update on the recruitment process for a permanent Emergency Manager position. He also discussed emergency alert systems, including Everbridge and Zonehaven, and explained the County's evacuation levels and decision-making process.

John Holmes, Illinois Valley Fire District Chief, presented on fire incident response procedures at the district level, including initial attack, deployment of resources, and rapid assessment strategies. He emphasized the importance of early decision-making and coordination with regional partners.

Mike Cook, Representative from the Oregon State Fire Marshal's Office, Regional Mobilization Coordinator, provided an overview of the State's role in supporting local agencies when resources are depleted. He explained coordination with local fire districts, BLM, and other agencies, as well as the process for mobilizing additional resources through the State.

Austin Prince, Rural Metro Fire District, explained that Rural Metro is responsible for a large portion of the County and works closely with ODF and other partners. He emphasized the importance of public education and community awareness in reducing fire risk.

Jimmy Sanchez, Grants Pass Fire Chief, stated that the City operates under similar response protocols and emphasized strong interagency relationships. He noted that the City has increased staffing and continues to coordinate closely with surrounding agencies for rapid response.

Dan Quinones, Oregon Department of Forestry, presented on ODF's responsibility to protect approximately two million acres of state and private lands under ORS 477. He discussed fire season preparedness, staffing levels, fuel reduction efforts, and predictive services used to anticipate fire conditions. (*Exhibit 1*)

Jeremy Delack, Fire Chief From the United States Forest Service, provided an overview of federal fire response operations across multiple counties and discussed suppression strategies, including direct and indirect approaches, as well as coordinated response efforts with state and local partners.

Michael McCain, Bureau of Land Management, discussed staffing, fuel reduction efforts, and coordination with partner agencies. He emphasized the importance of public information and prevention efforts in reducing wildfire risk.

Holly Powers and Allen Myers, Pacific Power, presented on infrastructure improvements and wildfire mitigation efforts, including grid hardening projects, replacement of power poles, and installation of covered

conductor systems. They also discussed customer programs related to emergency preparedness, outage communication, and financial assistance. (Exhibit 2)

3. The Board opened the floor to additional agency input and discussion.

Commissioner Smith requested updates on roadside fuel reduction and firebreak strategies.

Justin Kelly, Bureau of Land Management, and Scott Blower, U.S. Forest Service, provided updates on ongoing efforts to reduce roadside hazards and develop strategic firebreaks, including the use of “pod” boundaries and shaded fuel breaks to improve fire containment and firefighter access.

4. **Other**

None

5. **Additional Subject Matters from Commissioners/Announcements**

Commissioners expressed appreciation for the collaboration among agencies and emphasized the importance of continued coordination and public outreach efforts.

The meeting adjourned at 2:37 p.m.

Exhibit 1-Infographic

Exhibit 2-Informational Packet



RURAL METRO FIRE

THE BASIC RULES OF SAFE OPEN BURNING

🔥 Burn in the early morning hours when surrounding vegetation and air has the highest moisture content, and when winds are calm or light.

🔥 Build a dirt fire break around the perimeter of the pile that is free of flammable vegetation.

🔥 Keep piles small and manageable (4'x4'x4' or smaller in size), and not near any structures, vehicles, firewood stacks or miscellaneous yard clutter.

🔥 Avoid building burn piles in a remote part of your property that has limited access by fire trucks or your ability to have water available.

🔥 Have a reliable water source on hand, such as a charged garden hose with nozzle.

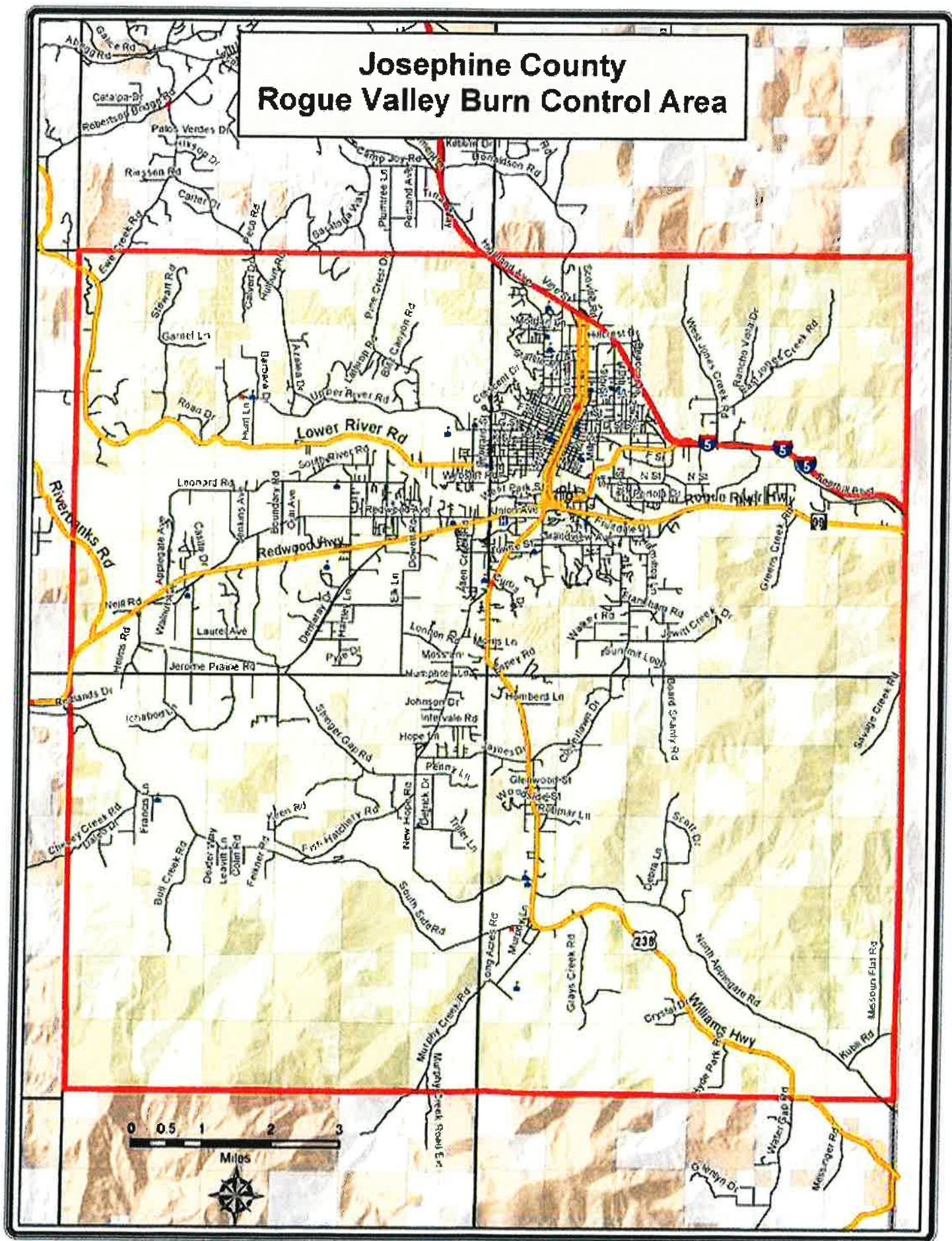
🔥 Stay in attendance of the burn so you can take action in case a stray ember floats out into the surrounding brush.

🔥 Keep a shovel and charged cell phone handy at all times, so that action can be taken and 911 can be called without delay.

Remember, you can always cancel firefighters if you get things under control (but why take the chance?).

For more information call (541) 474-1218

Josephine County Rogue Valley Burn Control Area





RURAL METRO FIRE

10 TIPS FOR “DEFENDING YOUR SPACE”

- 1) Make sure your address is well marked to help firefighters find you quickly. This includes forks on shared driveways. Ambulance and law enforcement like this also.
- 2) Make sure your gate code has been entered into 911. You can call our admin office to have it entered. Be sure to update if you change the code.
- 3) Attach a hose and nozzle to each outdoor water faucet for quick access by you or a passerby.
- 4) Strategically place sprinklers around perimeter of structures in dry vegetation. Set them to run for a few hours each afternoon to bring surface fuel moisture levels up. This can repel embers if a fire starts down the road. (be sure your water system can handle it)
- 5) Place water-filled containers, with lids and dipping pails, around perimeter for quick access to suppress spot fires.
- 6) Park RV's away from main structures, tuck in awnings and slide-outs.
- 7) Place patio furniture cushions inside when not in use.
- 8) Stack firewood and other flammables away from buildings and vehicles.
- 9) Keep windows closed when not at home.
- 10) Have a plan for pets and livestock evacuation.

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Public Use Restrictions During Fire Season



Burning of debris whether in burn piles, or burn barrels	Not allowed anytime	Not allowed anytime	Not allowed anytime	Not allowed anytime
Use of tracer ammunition & exploding targets	Not allowed anytime	Not allowed anytime	Not allowed anytime	Not allowed anytime
Use of fireworks on ODF-protected forestland	Not allowed anytime	Not allowed anytime	Not allowed anytime	Not allowed anytime
Smoking in areas of dry vegetation except in vehicles on improved roads, in boats on water, and other designated areas free of vegetation	Not allowed anytime	Not allowed anytime	Not allowed anytime	Not allowed anytime
Campfires, charcoal fires, cooking fires and warming fires. A shovel and water source is required. Liquefied or bottle-fueled camp stoves or fire pits are allowed at all times in cleared areas*	Allowed with landowner's permission	Allowed only at designated locations	Allowed only at designated locations	Allowed only at designated locations
Motor vehicles, including motorcycles & all-terrain, are only allowed on improved roads free of flammable vegetation, except for the culture/harvest of agricultural crops	Not restricted	Restricted at all times	Restricted at all times	Restricted at all times
Use of electric fence controllers shall be: listed by a nationally recognized testing lab or certified by the DCBS and follow the manufacturer's instructions	Required at all times	Required at all times	Required at all times	Required at all times

Use of power saws: When allowed, each saw is required to have one shovel and fire extinguisher of at least eight-ounce capacity. A firewatch of at least one hour is required following the use of each saw.	Allowed anytime	Shutdown required between 1:00 PM and 8:00 PM	Shutdown required between 10:00 AM and 8:00 PM	Not allowed anytime
Cutting, grinding & welding of metal: When allowed, activity must be conducted in a cleared area* that has a charged hose or one 2.5 pound or larger fire extinguisher available.	Allowed anytime	Shutdown required between 1:00 PM and 8:00 PM	Shutdown required between 10:00 AM and 8:00 PM	Not allowed anytime
Mowing of dried, cured grass: No restrictions on green lawns. The culture and harvest of agricultural crops is also exempt.	Allowed anytime	Shutdown required between 1:00 PM - 8:00 PM	Shutdown required between 10:00 AM - 8:00 PM	Not allowed anytime
Use of any other spark-emitting internal combustion engine not mentioned: When able, activities should be conducted in a cleared area* that has a charged garden hose or one 2.5 pound or larger fire extinguisher available.	Allowed anytime	Shutdown required between 1:00 PM and 8:00 PM	Shutdown required between 10:00 AM and 8:00 PM	Not allowed anytime
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*Cleared area means an area cleared of all flammable vegetation and debris in a 50-foot radius.

OUR SERVICES:

Ground-applied fire retardant treatments, defensible space creation, fuel reduction, home hardening, and property assessments—all tailored to your property. We integrate every layer of protection into a cohesive strategy. Using long-term solutions powered by Komodo Fire Systems, we create a protective barrier designed to reduce fire intensity and increase structure survivability.



Our team is comprised of factory-trained and certified applicators of Komodo Fire Systems fire retardant. Our solution is non-toxic, biodegradable, and safe around people, pets, wildlife, and vegetation, making it an easy and responsible choice without compromising effectiveness. Backed by the U.S. Forest Service and listed on the Qualified Products List (QPL), it delivers trusted, high-performance fire protection when it matters most.

KOMODO[®]
Komodo Fire Systems, Inc.

Our company is built on integrity and real-world experience. We take a professional and forward-thinking approach to wildfire defense, delivering solutions that work when it matters most. The future of wildfire defense is proactive. The future is Resilience.

Contact us today to protect what matters most.

Call today for a free estimate:

541-661-2421

Visit our website for more information:

preventwildfire.com



RESILIENCE[™]
WILDFIRE SOLUTIONS



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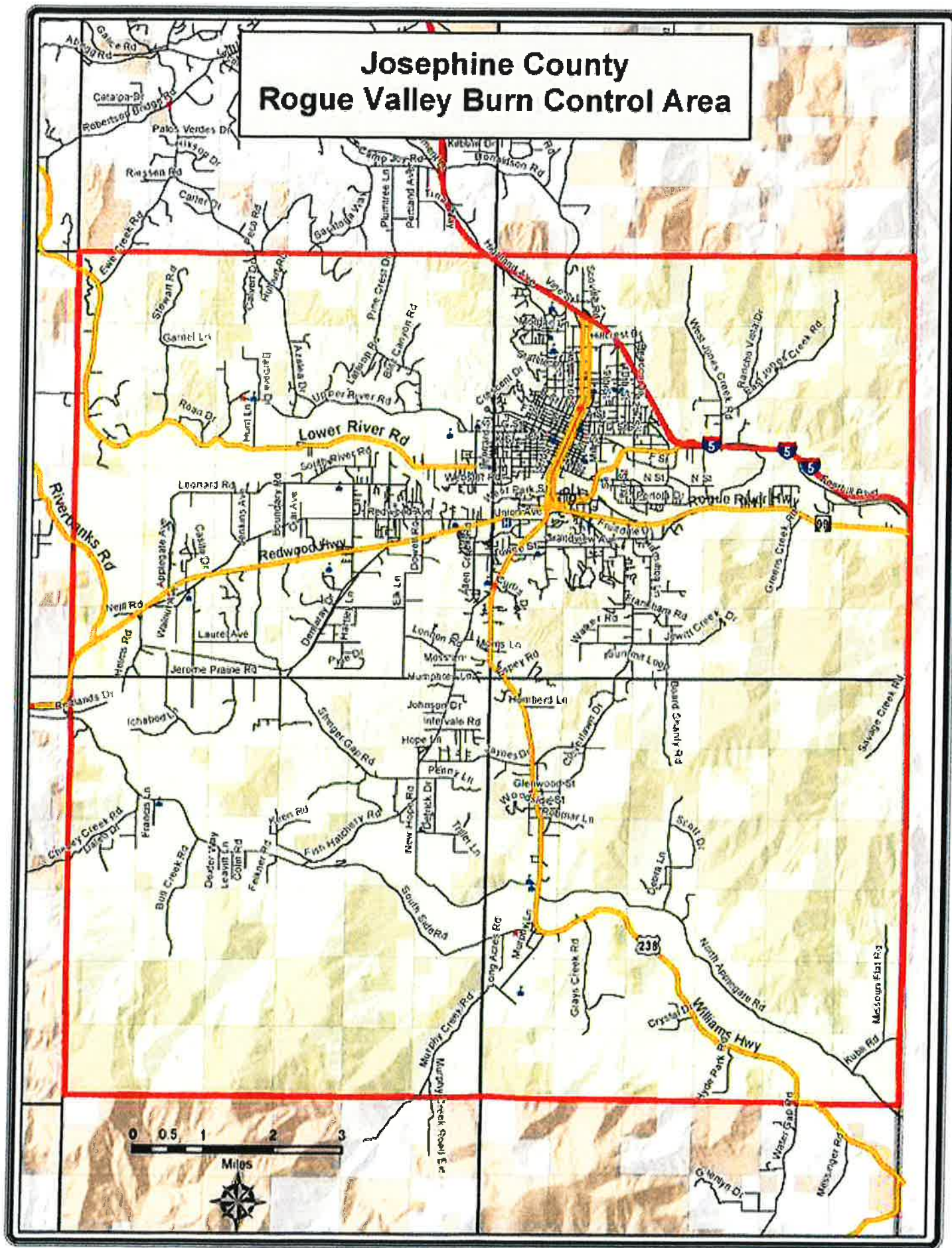
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Oregon Department of Forestry

Southwest Oregon District

2026 Fire Season Outlook and Resources

Kelsey Peak Fire, Sept. 2025



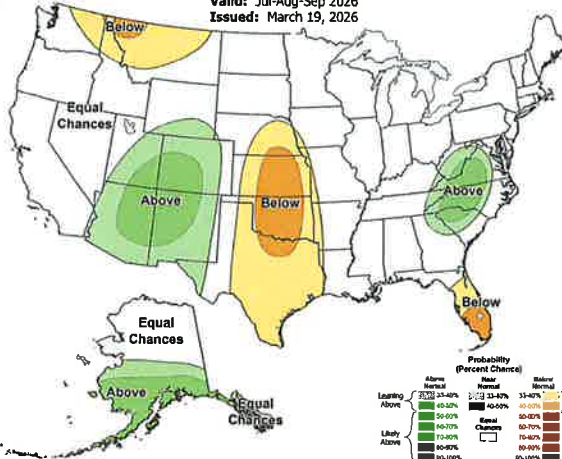
Medford Unit (District HQ) | 541.664.3328 | 5286 Table Rock Road, Central Point, OR 97502
Grants Pass Unit | 541.474.3152 | 5375 Monument Drive, Grants Pass, OR 97526

Current seasonal outlooks predict **normal chances for precipitation and above average temperatures July through September 2026, similar to last year.**



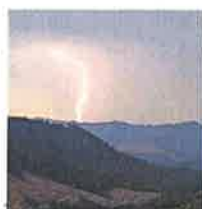
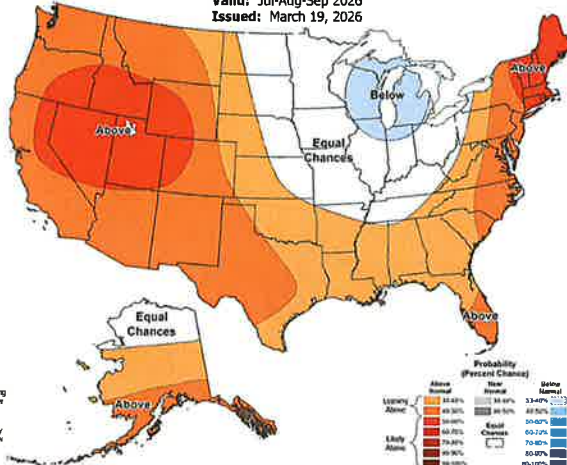
Seasonal Precipitation Outlook

Valid: Jul-Aug-Sep 2026
Issued: March 19, 2026



Seasonal Temperature Outlook

Valid: Jul-Aug-Sep 2026
Issued: March 19, 2026



ODF in Jackson and Josephine Counties

WINTER WORK

More than 50 acres of defensible space across the district

Jackson County:

- GNA - 600 acres of marking and surveys in Jackson Co.
- 60+ Firewise home assessments

Josephine County:

- GNA- 1,000 acres of planting and stocking surveys
- 445 acres of BLM units laid out
- Firewise defensible space work ongoing

AGENCY STANCE

- **3 IMTs ready and available**
- ODF is continuing to analyze how recently detailed changes within our federal partners' system will impact the agency
- **Fast, adaptive firefighting, safety to the public and firefighters, and quickly extinguished wildfires remain the top priorities of ODF in 2026**

STAFFING

- **Approx. 60 year-round staff members**
 - 35 at Medford HQ
 - 25 in Grants Pass
- **Approx. 150 seasonal staff**, including entry-level and experienced firefighters, dispatchers and detection specialists
- The district is fully staffed with permanent and seasonal positions each year June through October with Seven-day staffing during the declared season

RESOURCES

- **25 engines**
 - 13 in Medford
 - 12 in Grants Pass
- **7 staffed guard stations**
 - 4 in Medford
 - 3 in Grants Pass
- **4 helicopters**
 - Types 1, 2 & 3 in Medford
 - Type 2 in Grants Pass
- **1 air attack plane**
- **1 UAS**
 - 2 certified pilots
- **2 water tenders, 2 bulldozers and 2 hand crews**
 - One per unit
- **34 detection cameras**



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